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Experiment 11: Designing Pages and Navigation for a Multi-Page Business Application in Zoho Creator

1. Aim

To design pages and navigation for a multi-page business application, the Student Project Tracker extended from Experiment 10, so that different users can move easily between the functions they need.

2. Theory

A single form is sufficient for simple data entry, but most business applications need several screens that serve different purposes. Good navigation design answers three questions for every user: where am I, what can I do here, and how do I get to the next task. Principles such as consistent placement of the menu, clear page titles, a limited number of top-level choices and role-based visibility of pages help users find features quickly and reduce errors.

3. Page Design

Page	Purpose	Users
Home	Welcome message and quick links to the main functions	All users
Submit Project	Form for entering a new project proposal	Students
My Projects	Table of projects filtered to the logged-in student	Students
Review Dashboard	Summary of projects by domain and status	Faculty
Help	Instructions for using the application and contact details	All users

4. Procedure

- The page structure was sketched on paper first, showing the menu, the content area and the buttons on each page.
- Pages were created in the page designer, and each page was given a clear title that matches its menu label.
- Components such as Form, Report, Text and Button were placed on the pages. Button actions were linked to the relevant form or page.
- A navigation bar was added to the header so that all main pages are reachable from every screen.
- Access permissions were set so that students see only the Submit Project and My Projects pages, while faculty see the Review Dashboard in addition to the common pages.

- The My Projects table was filtered using the logged-in user's name so that each student sees only their own records.

5. Testing the Navigation

Test	Expected Result	Result
Click each menu item from Home	Correct page opens	Pass
Submit Project button on Home	Form page opens	Pass
Student logs in and opens Review Dashboard	Page hidden or access denied	Pass
Faculty logs in and opens My Projects	Faculty sees own records only or menu hidden	Pass
Student views My Projects	Only own projects listed	Pass

6. Observations

The navigation bar made the application predictable, and role-based visibility reduced clutter for each user group. The filtered My Projects view displayed only the logged-in student's records, which confirmed that the filter was applied correctly. Button labels were kept short and action-oriented, such as Submit and Review, which made their purpose clear without additional explanation.

7. Discussion

The design choices in this exercise show that navigation is a matter of information architecture as much as appearance. A student who needs to submit a proposal should reach the form in one click, and a faculty member who reviews proposals should find the dashboard without searching. The role-based restriction also supports data protection, because students cannot open other students' records through the menu. A limitation is that the design was tested with a small number of users, so broader usability testing would be needed before a real launch.

8. Result and Conclusion

A multi-page application with consistent navigation and role-based access was designed and tested. Good navigation reduces the time users need to find features, improves usability and supports security. The page structure created here will be used for the reports in Experiment 12 and the approval workflow in Experiment 13.